The Seven-Step Redesign Run Sheet

Start with the work. The workforce number comes last.

From ***AI Will Scale Good Leadership and Bad Leadership:*** *The CHRO's Method for Redesigning Work Before AI Scales What's Broken* by Liz Corey · Toolbox No. 5

HOW TO USE THIS RUN SHEET

1. Pick one high-visibility, high-volume process your function owns: tuition reimbursement, onboarding, leave administration, the raise request.
2. Run steps one through three in the next two weeks. Ask the should-it-exist question out loud.
3. Walk into your executive meeting carrying the map instead of a tool request. Run the steps in order. Do not skip ahead to step seven.

Process: _____ **Owner:** _____

	STEP	WHAT TO DO	OWNER / DATE
1	**Understand the work**	Take inventory with the people closest to it. Map the real job, not the official one. **Done when:** The task list came from the people who do the work, not the job description.	
2	**Quantify the work**	Build the taxonomy: function, process, activity, task. Capture volume, frequency, handling time, variability, value, legal requirement, and elimination potential at the task level. **Done when:** Every task has numbers on it.	
3	**Redesign the work**	Ask first: should this task exist at all? Classify every task: eliminate, simplify, automate, augment, retain. Then rebuild the flow: map the handoffs, approvals, and wait time, before and after. **Done when:** Both tests on page 2 pass.	
4	**Determine the technology and AI contribution**	Human, Assist, Automate, or Agent. Destination set by the cost of being wrong, never by capability alone. **Done when:** Every surviving task has a provisional destination.	
5	**Determine human capacity**	Convert the remaining work to hours. Divide by realistic productive capacity, never by paid hours. **Done when:** Required FTE is calculated on productive hours, about 125 to 135 a month.	
6	**Design roles and reinvest the capacity**	Build the jobs the redesigned work requires. Re-slot people by what they can actually do. **Done when:** You have written down what people will now do that they could not do before.	
7	**Calculate workforce**	Only now. Add up the roles the redesigned work requires. **Done when:** The number came out of the work. It did not go in.	

One distinction that saves arguments. A task that requires judgment is not off limits to AI. The process must pause for a person at the point where the judgment happens. Protect the moment of decision, not the whole task.

Task automation is not job automation. AI may change the administrative, analytical, and coordination parts of a job without eliminating the job. Fewer people or more volume is a leadership decision, not a technology one.

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STEP THREE

Two tests: did you redesign or merely digitize?

The elimination test. Can you point to a step that no longer exists? Not faster. Gone.	☐ Yes	☐ No
The customer test. Can the people you serve get a good result without knowing your process?	☐ Yes	☐ No

Two yeses: you redesigned. Any no: you digitized. Rebuild the flow and run the tests again.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Tuition reimbursement

THE OLD FLOW

The employee finds the form, guesses at eligibility, submits, and waits. A coordinator checks the policy and the numbers, routes to one approver, then a second, then payroll.

Three weeks. Four handoffs. Half the requests bounce for missing information.

DEPLOYED (DIGITIZED)

A chatbot in front of the same flow helps people fill out the form. Same steps, slightly faster. The employee still has to learn the process.

Fails both tests.

REDESIGNED

The employee states the course and the cost. The system answers eligibility instantly from the one governed policy. The numbers are verified automatically. The single approval that needs judgment goes to the one person whose judgment matters. Payroll gets clean data with no rekeying.

Steps eliminated. One approval instead of two. Passes both tests.

STEP FIVE

Capacity math: productive hours, never paid hours

THE WORK	THE COMMON MISTAKE	THE RIGHT ANSWER
400 hours 2,000 occurrences a month at 12 minutes each	~~**2.5 FTE**~~ 400 ÷ 160 paid hours	**3.1 FTE** 400 ÷ 130 productive hours

THE ENABLEMENT DIAGNOSTIC

Has your pilot become enablement?

A step no longer exists.	☐ Yes	☐ No
A task changed destination, and its decision rights were updated.	☐ Yes	☐ No
The freed capacity has a named reinvestment.	☐ Yes	☐ No
The customer of the process knows less about the process than before.	☐ Yes	☐ No
A named person owns the redesigned flow.	☐ Yes	☐ No

Five yeses is enablement. Zero is deployment with a transformation label. Anything in between is a pilot that hasn't finished the job.

Want steps one and two done for you? The Work Taxonomy Agent interviews the people who do the work and builds the task inventory with hours attached. Call for pricing. Book a conversation at onthegrow.ai

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